

Here is a comprehensive 10-page company policy document, structured in the format commonly used by Indian private limited companies and multinational corporations operating in India.

****Disclaimer:**** This document is a template for informational purposes only and does not constitute legal advice. Employment laws vary by jurisdiction and are subject to change. You should consult with a qualified legal professional to ensure compliance with all applicable central, state, and local laws.

[COMPANY NAME] PRIVATE LIMITED

EMPLOYEE HANDBOOK & HR POLICY MANUAL

****Version:**** 2.0

****Effective Date:**** July 6, 2026

****Applicability:**** All Full-Time Regular Employees (India Operations)

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1. INTRODUCTION & WELCOME

****1.1 Welcome Message****

Welcome to [Company Name] Private Limited ("the Company"). We are delighted to have you as part of our team. We believe that our employees are our most valuable asset, and we are committed to fostering a professional, inclusive, and growth-oriented work environment. This

Employee Handbook (the “Handbook”) is designed to acquaint you with the Company’s culture, policies, and your privileges and obligations as a member of our team.

****1.2 Objective****

The objective of this Handbook is to establish clear, fair, and consistent guidelines governing the terms and conditions of employment. It serves as a reference guide to help you understand the Company’s philosophy, work ethics, and operational procedures. This policy is based on the principles of natural justice and compliance with applicable labour laws, including but not limited to the Shops and Establishments Act, the Factories Act, the Sexual Harassment of Women at Workplace (Prevention, Prohibition and Redressal) Act, 2013, and relevant state-specific regulations.

****1.3 Scope****

This policy applies to all regular full-time employees of the Company working in India. It does not apply to contract labour, consultants, or interns, whose terms are governed by their respective agreements. In case of any conflict between this Handbook and an individual’s employment agreement, the terms of the employment agreement shall prevail, unless the policy provides a greater benefit as per law.

2. DEFINITIONS

Unless the context otherwise requires, the following terms shall have the meanings assigned to them:

- ****“Company”**** : [Company Name] Private Limited, its branches, and offices in India.
- ****“Employee”**** : Any person on the regular payroll of the Company.
- ****“Permanent Employee”**** : An employee who has successfully completed the probation period and has been confirmed in writing.
- ****“Probationer”**** : A newly hired employee serving a period of probation to assess their suitability for the role.
- ****“Manager”**** : The immediate supervisor or reporting authority of an employee.
- ****“Management”**** : The Board of Directors and designated leadership team of the Company.
- ****“Working Day”**** : A day on which the Company’s office is operational, typically Monday through Friday, excluding notified holidays.

3. EMPLOYMENT & CLASSIFICATION

****3.1 Employment Categories****

Employees are classified into the following categories for administrative purposes:

- ****Full-Time Permanent:**** Employees working the standard scheduled workweek with entitlement to all benefits.
- ****Probationary:**** All new employees shall undergo a probation period of six (6) months from the date of joining. This period may be extended by a further three (3) months at the sole discretion of the Management based on a performance review.
- ****Fixed-Term Contract:**** Employees hired for a specific duration or project. Their benefits are governed by their specific contract.

****3.2 Confirmation of Employment****

Upon satisfactory completion of the probation period, the employee will be issued a letter of confirmation. If performance is found unsatisfactory, the probation period may be extended or the employment may be terminated as per Section 10 of this policy.

****3.3 Employment of Relatives****

The employment of relatives of existing employees is generally discouraged if it creates a direct reporting relationship or a potential conflict of interest. All such cases must be pre-approved by the HR Department and Management.

****3.4 Background Verification****

This offer of employment is contingent upon the satisfactory completion of a background verification check, including past employment history, educational qualifications, and criminal records, as permissible under applicable law.

4. CODE OF CONDUCT & ANTI-HARASSMENT

****4.1 Core Values****

All employees are expected to uphold the highest standards of integrity, honesty, and professionalism. Our core values—Respect, Innovation, Transparency, and Excellence—must be reflected in every interaction with colleagues, clients, and stakeholders.

****4.2 Workplace Behaviour****

- ****Non-Discrimination:**** The Company is an equal opportunity employer. We prohibit discrimination based on race, religion, caste, gender, sexual orientation, marital status, age, disability, or any other characteristic protected under Indian law.
- ****Anti-Harassment (POSH):**** The Company has a zero-tolerance policy towards sexual harassment. We fully comply with the Sexual Harassment of Women at Workplace (Prevention, Prohibition and Redressal) Act, 2013. An Internal Committee (IC) has been constituted to address complaints. The detailed POSH policy is displayed on the notice board and intranet. Any act of harassment will lead to strict disciplinary action, up to and including termination of employment.
- ****Professionalism:**** Gossiping, spreading rumours, shouting, or using unprofessional language is prohibited.

****4.3 Prohibited Activities****

- Possession, use, or distribution of alcohol, narcotics, or any illegal substances on Company premises.
- Engaging in gambling, money lending, or any other illegal activity on Company premises.
- Unauthorized possession of weapons.
- Sleeping on duty during working hours.

****4.4 Conflict of Interest****

An employee must avoid any situation that involves a conflict between their personal interest and the interest of the Company. This includes:

- Engaging in any business activity that competes with the Company.
- Accepting gifts or favours of more than nominal value (over ₹1,000) from vendors, clients, or partners.
- Serving as a director, partner, or consultant to a competitor, supplier, or customer without prior written approval from Management.

****4.5 Dress Code****

Employees are expected to dress in a professional and appropriate manner. Business casuals (formal trousers, shirts, blouses, kurtas, sarees) are the standard. Employees must refrain from wearing revealing, ripped, or unprofessional attire. Designated casual days (e.g., Fridays) may allow smart casuals like clean jeans and T-shirts without offensive slogans.

5. WORKING HOURS, ATTENDANCE & PUNCTUALITY

****5.1 Standard Work Schedule****

The standard work week is 5 days, Monday to Friday. The official working hours are from ****9:30 AM to 6:30 PM****, with a one-hour lunch break from 1:00 PM to 2:00 PM. Employees must complete a minimum of 45 hours of work per week, excluding the lunch break.

****5.2 Flexible Work Arrangements****

Subject to business requirements and Manager approval, the Company may offer hybrid working options (e.g., work from home). Employees working remotely must be available on all official communication channels during core business hours (11:00 AM to 4:00 PM). Ad-hoc remote work requests must be approved via email 24 hours in advance.

****5.3 Attendance & Biometrics****

All employees are required to record their attendance using the biometric system or the designated digital attendance application. Manual registers will only be used in the event of a system failure. Failure to mark attendance correctly may result in a salary deduction for that day.

****5.4 Late Coming & Half-Day****

- An employee arriving after 10:00 AM will be marked as late.
- Three instances of late coming in a calendar month will result in a deduction of one day's salary.
- An employee arriving after 12:30 PM or leaving before 3:30 PM without prior approval will be considered as a half-day absence.

****5.5 Overtime****

Employees are expected to complete their tasks within regular working hours. For exigencies of work, if an employee is required to work beyond standard hours (before 9:00 AM or after 8:00 PM) or on a holiday, they will be granted compensatory off, as approved by their Manager. Overtime pay is applicable only to non-managerial staff as per the applicable Shops & Establishments Act of the state.

6. LEAVE POLICY

****6.1 Leave Year****

The leave year runs from January 1st to December 31st. All leaves are credited on a pro-rata basis for employees joining mid-year.

****6.2 Types of Leave****

The following paid and unpaid leaves are available to confirmed employees. Probationers are eligible for Sick Leave and pro-rated Casual Leave only.

Leave Type	Entitlement (per year)	Accrual	Max. Accumulation
:---	:---	:---	:---
Casual Leave (CL)	8 days	Pro-rated monthly	Not allowed. Lapses at year-end.
Sick Leave (SL)	8 days	Pro-rated monthly	Up to 30 days.
Earned/Privilege Leave (EL/PL)	18 days	1.5 days per month worked	Up to 45 days.
Bereavement Leave	5 days per instance	Immediately available	Not applicable

- ****Casual Leave (CL):**** For unforeseen circumstances or personal work. Cannot be combined with EL/PL for more than 3 days without Manager approval. Minimum of half-day application.
- ****Sick Leave (SL):**** For personal illness or injury. Medical certificate is mandatory for absence of more than 2 consecutive days.
- ****Earned/Privilege Leave (EL/PL):**** For planned vacations. Must be applied for at least 7 days in advance. Approval is subject to business exigencies.
- ****Bereavement Leave:**** In the unfortunate event of the demise of an immediate family member (spouse, children, parents, siblings, or parents-in-law).

****6.3 Maternity Leave****

Female employees are entitled to 26 weeks of paid maternity leave for the first two surviving children, in accordance with the Maternity Benefit (Amendment) Act, 2017. For the third child,

12 weeks of paid leave is provided (6 weeks pre-natal and 6 weeks post-natal). All related benefits, such as the Work from Home option post-leave (as mutually agreed) and crèche facility (where statutorily mandated), are applicable.

****6.4 Paternity Leave****

Male employees with less than two surviving children are entitled to 5 days of paternity leave, which can be availed within 15 days before or 30 days after the delivery of the child.

****6.5 Leave Without Pay (LWP)****

In genuine cases where an employee has exhausted all leave balance, a leave without pay may be sanctioned at the sole discretion of Management. The period of LWP exceeding 15 days in a calendar year will not be considered for gratuity or appraisal increments, unless governed by statutory provisions.

****6.6 Procedure****

All leave must be applied for via the HRMS (Human Resource Management System) portal. It is the employee's responsibility to ensure that leave is approved by their reporting manager before availing it. Absence without information for 3 consecutive days or more is considered a voluntary abandonment of employment.

7. COMPENSATION & BENEFITS

****7.1 Salary Structure****

The Cost to Company (CTC) is a comprehensive figure including fixed components (Basic, HRA, Conveyance, Special Allowance) and variable components (Statutory Bonus, Performance Incentives). The breakup is provided in the appointment letter and monthly payslips. The Company follows a standard Basic: DA ratio as per the minimum wage norms of the respective state.

****7.2 Salary Disbursement****

Salaries are processed on the ****last working day of each month**** and are directly credited to the employee's designated bank account. Any discrepancy in salary must be reported to the HR/Payroll department within 3 working days of the credit date.

****7.3 Statutory Deductions****

The Company deducts the employee's contribution towards:

- Provident Fund (PF): 12% of Basic + DA.
- Employee State Insurance (ESI): 0.75% of gross salary (applicable for employees earning up to ₹21,000, or as amended by statute).
- Professional Tax (PT): As applicable to the state of employment.
- Tax Deducted at Source (TDS): Based on the income tax declaration submitted by the employee.

****7.4 Reimbursements****

- ****Fuel & Conveyance:**** If part of CTC, employees must submit valid bills by the 5th of the subsequent month.
- ****Telephone Reimbursement:**** As per grade eligibility and on submission of bills.
- Reimbursements are processed along with the monthly payroll. Non-submission of bills on time will result in that month's component being treated as taxable special allowance.

****7.5 Company Property****

Laptops, access cards, SIM cards, and any other equipment provided are the property of the Company. The employee is responsible for their safekeeping and must return them in good condition (subject to normal wear and tear) on the last working day.

****7.6 Gratuity****

The Company provides gratuity as per the Payment of Gratuity Act, 1972. On completion of 5 years of continuous service, employees are eligible for gratuity calculated at 15 days' salary (Basic + DA) for every completed year of service.

8. PERFORMANCE MANAGEMENT

****8.1 Performance Appraisal Cycle****

The Company operates on an annual performance appraisal cycle (April to March). The process involves Goal Setting (April), Mid-Year Review (September), and Annual Review (March/April).

****8.2 Key Result Areas (KRAs)****

At the beginning of the financial year, every employee and their Manager will jointly define measurable KRAs. Performance will be rated on achievement of goals, demonstration of core competencies, and adherence to Company values.

****8.3 Confirmation Appraisal****

A structured appraisal is conducted at the end of the probation period to determine the employee's suitability for permanent employment.

****8.4 Performance Improvement Plan (PIP)****

If an employee's performance falls below the acceptable standard, they will be placed on a Performance Improvement Plan for a period of 30 to 60 days. During this period, specific targets and coaching will be provided. Failure to meet the PIP objectives may lead to termination of employment.

****8.5 Promotion & Career Development****

Promotions are based on merit, performance, potential, and organizational requirements. Merely meeting job expectations or serving a specific period in a role does not automatically

entitle an employee to a promotion. The Company encourages internal job postings (IJPs) for career advancement.

9. CONFIDENTIALITY, DATA PRIVACY & IT USAGE

9.1 Confidential Information

During the course of employment, employees will be exposed to Confidential Information, including but not limited to financial data, business strategies, customer lists, source code, trade secrets, and employee data. Any unauthorized disclosure, misuse, or copying of Confidential Information will be treated as a gross misconduct.

9.2 Non-Disclosure Agreement (NDA)

All employees are bound by the NDA and confidentiality clauses signed at the time of joining. These obligations survive the termination of employment indefinitely for trade secrets and for a period of 2 years for other business information.

9.3 Data Privacy

The Company is committed to protecting the personal data of its employees, customers, and partners. Employees must not share any personal data of colleagues (such as phone numbers, addresses, or salary details) without explicit consent, except for official business purposes.

9.4 IT and Communication Systems

- **Internet Usage:** The Company's internet facility is provided for business purposes. Access to websites containing explicit, violent, or pirated content is strictly prohibited.
- **Email:** The official email ID assigned is for business correspondence. The Company reserves the right to monitor emails sent and received via the corporate server in compliance with applicable law.
- **Software Piracy:** Installation of unlicensed or pirated software on Company systems is a serious offence.

9.5 Social Media

Employees are permitted to maintain personal social media profiles. However, when identifying yourself as a [Company Name] employee, you must clarify that your views are personal. Employees are prohibited from posting derogatory comments about the Company, clients, or colleagues on any public platform.

10. SEPARATION OF EMPLOYMENT

10.1 Resignation

An employee may resign from the services of the Company by giving written notice. The notice period for confirmed employees is:

- **Junior Management & Staff:** 30 days.
- **Middle & Senior Management:** 60 to 90 days (as per appointment letter).

The Company may, at its sole discretion, waive the notice period by accepting a payment in lieu of notice based on gross salary.

****10.2 Termination by Company****

The Company may terminate an employee's services by giving the statutory notice period (or pay in lieu thereof). Termination may occur under the following circumstances:

- Unsatisfactory performance post a PIP.
- Redundancy or closure of a specific business unit.
- Misconduct proved during a domestic enquiry.
- Breach of Company policies, including confidentiality and anti-harassment policies.

****10.3 Exit Formalities & F&F Settlement****

An employee must obtain a "No Dues Certificate" from all departments (IT, Finance, Administration, etc.). The Full and Final (F&F) settlement, including pending salary, leave encashment of eligible leaves (as per policy cap), and gratuity, will be processed within 45 days from the date of relieving, subject to clearance of all dues.

****10.4 Absconding****

If an employee remains absent without sanctioned leave for a period of 3 consecutive days, without informing their Manager or HR, it shall be deemed as voluntary abandonment of employment (absconding). The Company will issue a notice to the last known address. In such cases, the Company reserves the right to forfeit any unpaid salary or benefits in lieu of the notice period not served, strictly in compliance with relevant laws.

11. GRIEVANCE REDRESSAL

****11.1 Policy****

The Company believes in an "Open Door" policy where employees are encouraged to discuss their grievances with their immediate supervisor. If the issue is not resolved, or if the employee is uncomfortable discussing it with the supervisor, a formal grievance mechanism is in place.

****11.2 Procedure****

1. ****Step 1:**** The employee must submit a written grievance to the Head of HR within a reasonable time of the occurrence of the issue.
2. ****Step 2:**** The Head of HR shall acknowledge the complaint within 48 hours and initiate an investigation.
3. ****Step 3:**** A committee comprising the Head of HR and a senior management representative will hear the grievance and provide a resolution within 14 working days.

4. ****Appeal:**** If dissatisfied with the resolution, the employee can appeal to the CEO/Managing Director, whose decision will be final and binding.

****11.3 Whistleblower Policy****

Employees can report cases of financial fraud, corruption, or serious ethical violations through a dedicated confidential email ID: ****[email address removed]**** . The identity of the whistleblower will be protected, and retaliation of any kind is strictly prohibited.

12. AMENDMENT & ACKNOWLEDGEMENT

****12.1 Amendments****

The Management reserves the right to amend, modify, or withdraw any provision of this Handbook without prior notice, in compliance with applicable laws. Any changes will be communicated via official email and updated on the Company intranet.

****12.2 Severability****

If any provision of this Handbook is determined to be invalid or unenforceable under any law, the remainder of the provisions will remain in full force and effect.

****12.3 Acknowledgement****

I, _____ (Employee Name), Employee ID: _____, acknowledge that I have received, read, and understood the policies contained in the [Company Name] Employee Handbook. I agree to abide by the terms and conditions set forth herein. I understand that this Handbook is not a contract of employment and does not guarantee employment for any specific duration.

****Signature:**** _____ ****Date:**** _____

******(This page is to be signed by the employee and stored in the personal HR file.)******

****[END OF DOCUMENT]****
